

User Guide: Audit Log

Record who created, changed, deleted, read or exported which records in Odoo, with old and new values for every changed field.

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1. What does this module do

Audit Log keeps a tamper-evident history of operations on the Odoo models you choose. You create one **rule** per model (for example Contact), pick which operations to track, and confirm the rule. From then on every tracked operation produces a **log** (who, when, which record, which operation) with one **log line** per changed field showing the old and new value. Auditors, administrators and compliance officers use it to answer "who changed this, and what was it before?".

Capability	Details
Per-model audit rules	One rule per model (<code>auditlog.rule</code>); a second rule on the same model is refused with "There is already a rule defined on this model."
Tracked operations	Creates, Writes, Deletes, Reads and Exports, each switched on/off individually
Field-level history	Each log line stores the field label, technical name, raw and human-readable old/new value
Readable relational values	Many2one and many2many/one2many values are shown as record names; a record that no longer exists shows as <code><id> (DELETED)</code>

Deleted-record snapshot	With Capture Record , a delete log keeps all field values of the record as it was just before deletion
Export tracking	One log per export listing the exported record ids, with an Exported Records smart button that re-opens them
Exclusions	Users to Exclude (e.g. integration users) and Fields to Exclude (e.g. notes) per rule
Session and request trail	Each log links to the user session and the HTTP request (URL path) that produced it
Multi-company isolation	Logs carry the audited record's company; users only see logs of their allowed companies
Retention	Optional scheduled action deletes audit data older than 180 days
"View logs" shortcut	Confirming a rule adds a View logs action to the audited model's form (Actions menu)

2. Where to find it in Odoo

The module lives in the technical settings, so **developer mode must be active** (Settings → Activate the developer mode). The parent menu **Audit** is visible only to Settings administrators (`base.group_system`).

Path: Settings → Technical → Audit

Menu	Purpose	Who sees it
Rules	Create, confirm and reset audit rules	Auditlog User (read), Auditlog Manager (edit)
Logs	One line per audited operation; open for the field changes	Auditlog User and up
Log Lines	Flat list of every field change across all logs, searchable by old/new value	Only Access Rights (<code>base.group_erp_manager</code>)
User sessions	Login sessions that produced logs, with their HTTP requests	Auditlog User and up
HTTP Requests	Individual requests (URL path + root URL) and the logs they produced	Auditlog User and up
Delete Old Logs	Dialog that purges old audit data now (see Retention)	Auditlog Manager

Additionally, on any audited model's form view (for example a contact), **Actions (gear icon) → View logs** lists the logs of that one record.

On a rule's form, the **Logs** smart button (top right, e.g. **29 Logs**) opens every log of the rule's model.

3. First-run setup: creating an audit rule

⚠ Nothing is logged until at least one rule is **Confirmed**.

Path: Settings → Technical → Audit → Rules → New

Field	What to enter	Example
Name	Free label for the rule	Partner audit trail
Model	The model to audit. Transient models and the <code>auditlog.*</code> models themselves cannot be selected	Contact (<code>res.partner</code>)
Type	Full log (default) or Fast log — see section 6	Full log
On Logging Failure	Block the operation (default) or Skip the log — see section 7	Block the operation
Log Creates	Track record creation (default on)	✓
Log Writes	Track modifications (default on)	✓
Log Deletes	Track deletions (default on)	✓
Log Reads	Track every read/open of a record (default off — expensive)	✗
Log Exports	Track exports (default on)	✓
Capture Record	On delete, keep a full snapshot of the deleted record's values	✓
Users to Exclude (tab)	Users whose operations are never logged	OdooBot, an API integration user
Fields to Exclude (tab)	Fields of the chosen model that never produce a log line	Notes (<code>comment</code>)

Then click **Confirm**. The status bar moves from **Draft** to **Confirmed**, the created "View logs" action is bound to the model's form (its technical record is shown as the read-only **Action** field in developer mode only), and auditing starts immediately. Use the **Logs** smart button to jump to the rule's logs.

Status flow: Draft → Confirmed (→ Set to Draft → Draft)

🔒 Once a rule is Confirmed, all its configuration fields are read-only. To change the operations, type or exclusions, click **Set to Draft**, edit, and click **Confirm** again. While a rule is in Draft nothing is logged for that model and the "View logs" action disappears from the model's form; re-confirming reuses the same action.

4. Reading the logs

Path: Settings → Technical → Audit → Logs

The list shows **Date**, **Resource Name**, **Model**, **Method** (`create`, `write`, `unlink`, `read`, `export_data`) and **User**. Optional columns: Resource ID, Type and (for multi-company users) Company.

Filters: **Create**, **Write**, **Delete**, **Read**, **Export**. Group by: **User**, **Model**, **Method**, **Company**, **Date**.

Opening a log shows:

Area	Content
Log group	Date, User, Method, Type, Company (multi-company only)
Resource group	Resource Name, Model, Technical Model Name, Resource ID, Resource IDs (exports only)
Fields updated tab	One line per field: Description, Old value Text, New value Text (raw values and technical name available as optional columns)
Technical tab	Session and HTTP Request that produced the log
Exported Records smart button	Only on export logs: opens the exported records (fails with a clear message if the model has been uninstalled)

Logs, sessions and requests are read-only in the interface (no Create/Edit buttons).

Log Lines (Settings → Technical → Audit → Log Lines) is a flat, read-only view of every field change, useful for questions like "who ever set this email?". Search by **Old value Text** / **New value Text**, filter by Create/Write/Delete and group by User, Model, **Field** or Company.

5. Core workflows

Journey 1: Find out who renamed a customer (worked example)

Setup: rule Partner audit trail on `Contact`, Full log, Log Writes enabled, Confirmed.

1. A salesperson opens the contact **Azure Interior** and changes **Name** to `Azure Interior SA`, then saves.
2. Exactly **one** `write` log is created:

Log field	Value
Resource Name	Azure Interior SA
Model	Contact
Method	write
User	the salesperson
Type	Full log

3. Its **Fields updated** tab has one line per changed field — here the one field the user edited:

Description	Old value Text	New value Text
Name	Azure Interior	Azure Interior SA

Because a full log compares all stored fields, a stored computed field that changes as a consequence (on contacts, typically **Complete Name**) gets its own line with the same old/new text. Nothing else is listed.

- The auditor finds it either via **Logs** → filter **Write** → search `Azure`, or directly from the contact form: **Actions** → **View logs**.

Fields whose value did not change produce no line; `create_date`, `write_date`, `create_uid`, `write_uid` and `display_name` are never logged.

Journey 2: Investigate a deleted record

With **Log Deletes** and **Capture Record** enabled, deleting a contact creates an `unlink` log whose **Fields updated** tab lists every stored field with its last value in **Old value Text**. Without Capture Record the `unlink` log still records who deleted which record id, but with no lines.

Journey 3: Check what was exported

With **Log Exports**, each export (list view → select → Actions → Export) creates one `export_data` log. **Resource IDs** holds the JSON list of exported ids; the **Exported Records** smart button (e.g. "12 Exported Records") re-opens exactly those records. Reading done internally by the export is not logged separately, so an export does not flood the log with read entries.

Journey 4: Exclude a noisy user or field

Set the rule to Draft, add the user in **Users to Exclude** or the field in **Fields to Exclude**, and Confirm. From the next operation on, the excluded user's actions are not logged at all, and the excluded field never gets a log line (other changed fields in the same save still do).

6. Full log vs fast log

	Full log (default)	Fast log
What is read	All stored, non-binary fields of the record before and after the operation	Nothing extra — only the values passed to create/write
Old values on write	Real previous values	Always shown as <code>False</code>
Side-effect changes (stored computed fields)	Logged	Not logged
Cost	Two extra reads per write	Minimal
Best for	Compliance, small/medium-volume models	High-volume models where "what was sent" is enough

Example — the same rename with Fast log: the line shows **Old value Text** `False`, **New value Text** `Azure Interior SA`. You know what was written, but not what it replaced.

Common to both types:

- On **create**, fields with empty initial values (empty text, `False`, empty lists) are skipped, so a new contact with only Name and Email produces two lines, not forty.
- Binary fields (images, attachments) are never logged.
- Relational values are displayed by name, e.g. Tags `VIP`, `Wholesale`; a tag that no longer exists shows as `7 (DELETED)`.

7. Failure policy, multi-company and retention

On Logging Failure

Setting	If writing the audit record fails...	Use when
Block the operation (default)	The user's operation is rolled back and the user sees the error. No change without a trace.	Compliance requires a guaranteed trail
Skip the log	The user's operation completes; the error is written to the server log; no audit record exists for that operation	Business continuity matters more than completeness

Live configuration

The rule's type, exclusions, Capture Record and failure policy are read from the database at **every** logged operation, so a change becomes effective immediately in every server worker — no restart needed.

Multi-company

- Each log stores the **company of the audited record** (when the model has a `company_id` field); exports get a company only if all exported records share one.
- Logs, log lines, the Log Lines view, user sessions and HTTP requests are visible only if their company is among the user's **allowed companies**, or if they have no company (e.g. logs of models without a company field).
- Rules themselves are global: one rule on `Contact` audits contacts of every company.
- The **Company** column/filter/group-by is hidden for single-company users and appears for users in multi-company mode.

Example: a Contact of Auditlog Demo Company B is edited. A user whose allowed companies are only the main company does not see that log in **Logs** or **Log Lines**; a user allowed in both companies does.

Retention (auto-vacuum)

Path: Settings → Technical → Automation → Scheduled Actions → **Auto-vacuum audit logs**

Property	Value
Shipped state	Inactive — nothing is ever deleted until you activate it
Frequency	Every 1 day
Code	<code>model.autovacuum(180)</code> — keeps 180 days
What is deleted	Logs (with their lines), HTTP requests and user sessions older than the retention period, oldest first

To keep one year, change the code to `model.autovacuum(365)` and tick **Active**. Only Auditlog Managers can run the vacuum.

Run it now: Settings → Technical → Audit → **Delete Old Logs** opens a dialog with **Keep Last (Days)** (default 180) and **Chunk Size** (0 = no limit; otherwise the maximum number of records removed per model in this run). Click **Delete Old Logs**: a notification confirms "Audit data older than 180 days has been deleted." Example: with Keep Last (Days) = 90 on 25 Sep 2026, every log created on or before 27 Jun 2026 is deleted together with its log lines, while logs from July onwards stay.

Sessions and requests

- **User sessions:** the **Session ID** is a SHA-256 fingerprint of the HTTP session identifier, never the raw id, so it cannot be used to hijack a session. Display name: `<user> (<date>)`.
- **HTTP Requests:** stores **Path** (e.g. `/web/dataset/call_kw/res.partner/web_save`), **Root URL**, user, session and linked logs. The user context is not stored.
- Operations done outside an HTTP request (scheduled actions, shell scripts) produce logs without session/request.

8. Demo data

When installed with demo data, the module provides:

Record	Details
Rule Partner audit trail	On <code>Contact</code> , Confirmed, excludes the Notes (<code>comment</code>) field
Company Auditlog Demo Company B	Second company to try multi-company visibility
User audit_viewer (password <code>audit_viewer</code>)	Auditlog User, restricted to the main company — log in to see that Company B logs are hidden
~20 sample logs	Mix of create/write/unlink entries to explore filters and grouping



▲ Change or deactivate the `audit_viewer` user on any database reachable from outside.

9. Access roles

Role	Rules	Logs / Log lines / Sessions / Requests	Log Lines menu	Auto-vacuum
Auditlog User	✓ Read	✓ Read (own allowed companies)	✗ (unless also Access Rights)	✗
Auditlog Manager (implies User)	✓ Read, create, edit, delete, Confirm / Set to Draft	✓ Full (own allowed companies)	✗ (unless also Access Rights)	✓
Access Rights (<code>base.group_erp_manager</code>)	—	—	✓ Read	—
Settings (<code>base.group_system</code>)	Automatically Auditlog Manager	Automatically Auditlog Manager	✓ (Settings implies Access Rights)	✓

The admin user is made Auditlog Manager at install. Because the **Audit** menu sits under **Settings** → **Technical**, a user needs the Settings role and developer mode to reach it through the menu.

To assign: **Settings** → **Users & Companies** → **Users** → select user → **Auditlog Rights** field on the Access Rights tab.

10. Limitations

Topic	Limitation
Implementation technique	The module patches ORM methods (<code>create</code> , <code>write</code> , <code>unlink</code> , <code>read</code> , <code>export_data</code>) on the audited model classes at registry level, the same technique as Odoo's <code>base_automation</code> . It is robust within a release, but budget a review/rewrite on each major Odoo upgrade.
Read logging	Log Reads writes one log per read record on every read, including list views and automatic reads. On high-traffic models (contacts, products) this grows the database fast and slows the UI. Enable only on sensitive, low-volume models.
Fast log	Cannot show old values (always <code>False</code>) and does not capture side-effect changes.



Log Lines view	A read-only database view; it cannot be edited or deleted from and is purged only via its underlying logs.
Read-only transactions	Logs produced during read-only requests (e.g. read logging) are written in a separate database cursor, so they persist even if the request itself later fails.
Direct SQL	Changes made by raw SQL, or by code that bypasses the ORM methods, are not logged.
Binary fields	Images and files are never logged.
Rule scope	One rule per model; rules cannot be restricted to a company or a record domain; <code>auditlog.*</code> and transient models cannot be audited.
Editing a confirmed rule	Configuration is read-only while Confirmed; use Set to Draft → edit → Confirm (nothing is logged while in Draft).
Tamper resistance	Auditlog Managers (and therefore Settings admins) can delete logs. The module is an audit trail, not a cryptographically sealed ledger.
Retention	The auto-vacuum cron ships inactive; without activating it logs grow indefinitely.
Integrations	No export to SIEM or external log systems; no reports (PDF).